

The very first thing you need to do is see the different Color schemes available for the selected theme. For example, the default Windows XP theme comes with Blue (default), Green and Silver options. First try out these options before you go any further. The next thing to modify is the 'Font size' option. Here you can choose between 'Normal', 'Large Fonts' and 'Extra Large Fonts'. To illustrate what this does, just select each one and look at the preview window to see the changes being reflected. You can always click 'Apply' to see the difference in your Windows GUI.



The Appearance settings

Now you should pay attention to the two buttons on the right, namely 'Effects...' and 'Advanced'. The 'Effects...' button brings up a dialog box that will show you various options. These are pretty self explanatory. Experiment!

The 'Advanced' button opens up an 'Advanced Appearance' box, which will let you customise everything from the colour of the blank background on the Desktop to the font types and sizes used to name icons and windows. Just check the 'Item' drop-down box to select what you would like to change and then change the colours, fonts and formatting on the right. This can greatly help you make your own unique looking Desktop, but be careful—you may end up ruining everything and get this ugly-looking Desktop that you hate—with fonts that are too large, colour combinations that border on the gaudy, and so on. Thankfully, you can just go back to the Themes tab and select 'Windows XP' to start over!

The Settings Tab

The last tab in the 'Display Properties' window is the 'Settings' tab. This tab helps you select screen resolutions and colour depths. Of most significance is the 'Advanced' button on the right, which will bring up your display adapter properties box. From here you can select the best resolution and refresh rate that your monitor sup-